2 Digital literacy: Using the world wide web

You will learn

- how to find information using a web search
- how to spot unsuitable content and behaviour on the internet and world wide web
- how you can report your concerns if you see content or behaviour that upsets you.

We use information every day. We use it to learn, to do our jobs and to enjoy our free time. The world wide web is a great source of information. In this unit you will learn how to search the world wide web to find the information you need. You will learn how to stay safe when using the world wide web.



Talk about...

- What do you like about the internet?
- What do you dislike about the internet?



Learning outcomes: Find information using a web search; Describe how to spot unsuitable internet content and behaviour; describe several ways you can report your concerns



Class activity

Talk about how you use the internet.

Make a list of when you:

- have used the internet for fun
- have used the internet to help with school work
- have been upset by the internet.

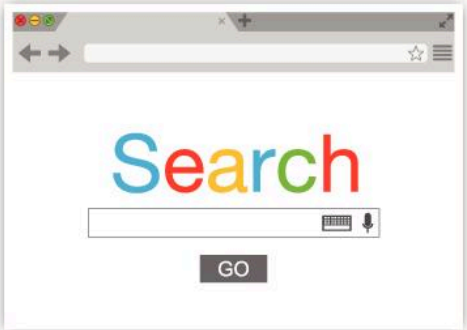
world wide web web page
website web browser
search engine key word
bookmark menu link



Did you know?

There are more than 4 billion people who use the internet worldwide. That is just over half of the world's total population.

At the time of writing, the Google search engine answers 7 billion questions every day. Google has answered around half a million questions while you were reading this!



2.1 About the world wide web

In this lesson

You will learn:

- about the world wide web.

Spiral back

Last year, you learned how to send and receive emails. The internet is used to send emails. In this unit you will learn about another internet service. This service is called the world wide web.

What is the world wide web?

You have probably used the **world wide web**. If you haven't, you will have heard about it. The world wide web is usually shortened to 'www' or 'the web' (we will call it 'the web' in this unit). The web is a great source of information. If you use it in the right way, it will help you to learn at school and at home.

What is a web page?

The information on the web is on **web pages**. A web page contains information about a single topic. A web page might be about your favourite singer or a topic you are studying at school.



A web page can contain text, images, video, sound and animations. These different types of information are called **media**. A web page usually combines several media formats; text and images for example. We say that web pages are **multimedia**.

What is a web link?

Every web page contains **web links**. A web link can be a word or a picture or a button. Clicking a web link takes you to another web page. Web links are what makes the web special. You can follow links to find new information.

What is a website?

Web pages are kept together on a **website**, like pages in a book. A website is owned by a person or organisation. Governments own websites. Newspapers and TV channels own websites. Anyone can own a website.

Browsing the web



When you use the web, you can go to a website you like and look through the web pages on that site. Sometimes you may move from one website to another to find information you are interested in. This is called **browsing**. We will discuss it in more detail in Lesson 2.4.

What is a web browser?

You use a special application to browse the internet. The application is called a **web browser**. Some popular web browsers are Internet Explorer, Firefox and Google Chrome.

Did you know?

Tim Berners-Lee is a British computer scientist. He invented the world wide web in 1990. He called it 'a lesson for all dreamers … that you can have a dream and it can come true'.





Activity

In a small group, make a questionnaire to find out what your class use the internet for. Here are some ideas: playing games, chatting to friends, sending emails, watching videos, doing school work.



Explore more

If you have time, ask family members to do the survey. What do the results show?



Extra challenge

Create a poster called 'A guide to the world wide web'. Your poster should explain the main terms people need to know about the web (for example 'website', 'web browser'). Try to present the information in an interesting way so that people will remember what the terms mean.

2.2 Searching the web

In this lesson

You will learn:

- how to use a search engine to carry out a basic search on the world wide web.

Search engines

Typing a question into a **search engine** is a good way to find information. The search engine looks at your question and provides you with a list of web pages. Some of those web pages will contain the information you need.



Tips for searching the web

1 Use a short clear question

Think about the information you are trying to find. Identify the **key words** and use them in your search. You should be able to find information using three to five words.

A web search question is not like a question you ask in conversation.

- In conversation, you might ask: Who holds the world record in the 100 metres for women?
- In a web search, you only need to use the key words. In this example, the key words are 'world record 100 metres women'.





Activity

Sunny is working on a project about big cats. He is researching the jaguar. He wants to find facts about the jaguar's diet and habitat.

Write down four or five key words that describe Sunny's task. We've included a letter/ letters from some key words to help you.

b___ c___	j_____	f_____	d_____	h_____

Experiment with the key words in an internet search. Can you find the information Sunny needs? How many key words did you use? What is the best combination of key words?

2 Think about the best order for your key words

The most important key words should come first. In this example, the word jaguar should come near the start of your search.

3 Do not use punctuation or short, common words

A search question does not need to be written in full. Leave out punctuation marks like commas, full stops and question marks. You can also leave out short, common words like 'and', 'the' and 'a'.



Activity

Selina loves pizza. She wants to find a recipe for a pizza to cook at home. Her favourite pizza is margherita, but she would like to see recipes for other vegetarian pizzas.

She enters the word 'pizza' into a search engine.

Do the same, to see what results Selina got. Can you help her to write a search question that finds the information she wants?



Think again

Write down a question that you don't know the answer to. For example: How many Olympic medals did Usain Bolt win? or What is the population of China? Then swap your question with a classmate. Who can find the answer first using a search engine?



Extra challenge

In Unit 1, you learned that car factories use robots to make cars. Use a search engine to find a picture of robots at work in a car factory.

2.3 Improving your web search

In this lesson

You will learn:

- how to improve a basic web search.

In the last lesson you learned how to use key words to carry out a basic search. In this lesson you will learn how to make your searches more useful.

Removing items from a search

In the last lesson you helped Selina search for vegetarian pizza recipes. You may have used a search question like this one:

pizza recipe vegetarian

The sites you found will have included recipes for margherita pizza. Selina already knows about that type of pizza, so it isn't what she is looking for. You can remove 'margherita' from the search using a minus symbol (–). The new search looks like this:

pizza recipe vegetarian -margherita



Activity

Enter the search string 'pizza recipe vegetarian' and look at the first page of results. Now enter 'pizza recipe vegetarian -margherita'. Are there any changes in the search results?



Be creative

Use your web search skills to create an advert for your favourite pizza. Write a short paragraph that tells people how good your pizza is!



Searching for books and music

You can use other symbols to improve your search. Two symbols that are often used are quote marks (") and an asterisk (*).

If you use double quote marks, the search engine looks for the exact text you have typed. Quote marks are very helpful if you are searching for a book or song title, for example '"The Tiger Who Came to Tea"'.

Use an asterisk if you aren't sure about a word in a song or book title. For example, if you are not sure of the third word in the book, *Where the Wild Things Are*, you could type '"Where the * Things Are"' in your search.



Activity

Search for a review of your favourite book. Use quote marks around the book title.

Use an asterisk to search for a book where you are unsure of the full title.

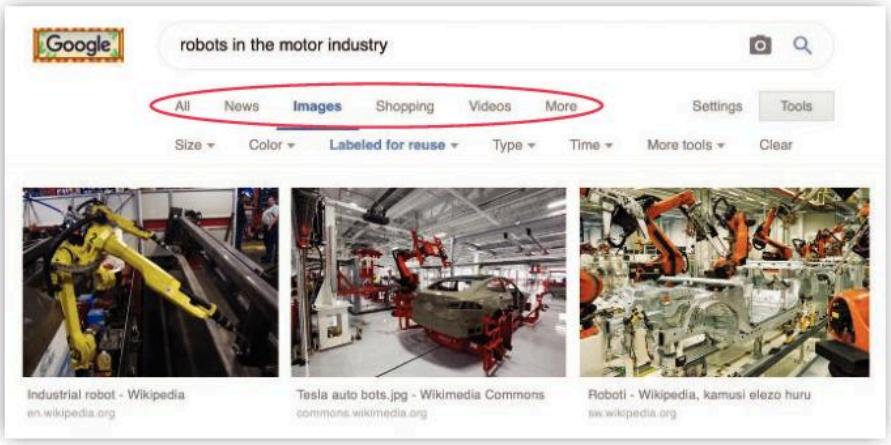


Extra challenge

Use your new skills to help with a piece of homework in another subject.

Searching for pictures and videos

When you have entered a search, a list of links is sent to your browser by the search engine. To see pictures and videos that match your search, click the 'Images' and 'Videos' links underneath the search box.





Explore more

Do other members of your family use the internet? You have learned some useful search skills in this unit. Share them with your family to help them when they use the internet.

2.4 Browsing and using bookmarks

In this lesson

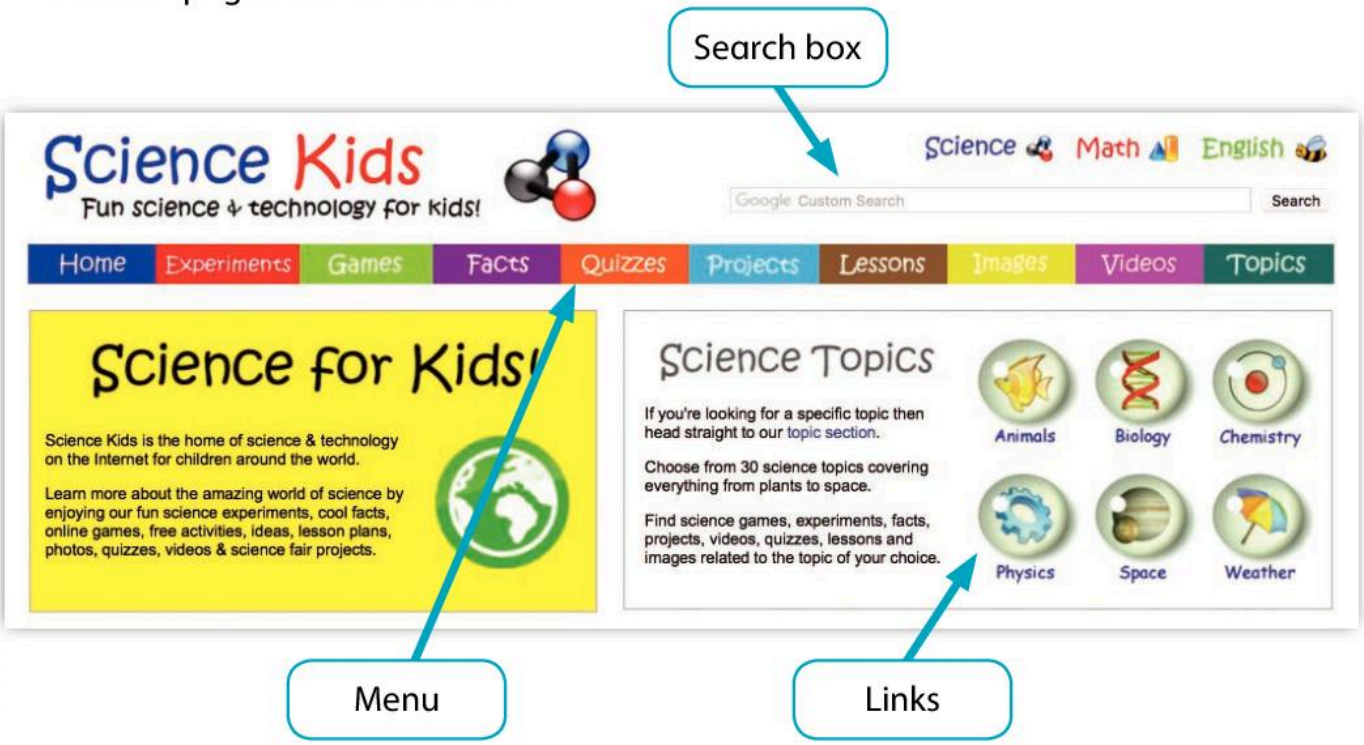
You will learn:

- how to find your way around a website
- how to use bookmarks, so that you can find a website or web page easily.

Finding your way around a website

When you have found a website you are interested in, you can start to browse. You browse a website by moving around the web pages on the site. You don't have to move through a website page by page as you would in a book. A website provides links that take you to the information you are looking for.

- The **menu** tells you how the website is divided into sections. A menu is like the contents page in a book. Clicking on a menu tab takes you to a different section of the website.
- **Links** usually take you to another page on the website. Links can be words or pictures.
- **Search** is like the search engine you have been using, but only searches pages on the website.



Be creative

Write a review of your favourite website. What is the site called? What is it about? What do you like about the site? Is there anything you would improve about the site? Share your review with your friends.

Bookmarks

Bookmarks save useful websites and web pages, so that you can find them again easily. Bookmarks help you get back to a website quickly.

In Lesson 1.5, you learned about saving files in folders. Folders help you to find information you have saved.



You can save your bookmarks into folders. For example, you could have one bookmark folder for each subject you study.

Activity

Work in a small team. Use your web search skills to find websites that have fact files about endangered animals. Use the menu, links and search buttons to find information on different endangered animals.

Choose one endangered animal. Create a poster about it to make people aware that the animal is in danger.

Think again

Create a bookmark folder called Computing. Save the useful sites you find in the folder as you study this course.

As you develop your web search skills, use the internet to research other subjects.

Extra challenge

Create a bookmark for the sites you used in the activity.

2.5 How to spot unsuitable content

In this lesson

You will learn:

- how to spot unsuitable content and behaviour when using the web
- what to do if something upsets you or is confusing.

The good and bad sides of the web

You can use the web to find information and facts to help you with homework and projects. The web is also a place where you can have fun talking to friends and sharing news. You can watch films, listen to music and play games.

However, the web has a bad side too. Some of the information you find will be misleading or incorrect. You cannot trust everything you see on the web.

Be alert, act responsibly and ask for help when you need it. If you are careful, then you can enjoy learning on the web.

How to check content

Is it true?

You should ask this question every time you use the web.

Sometimes, people get facts wrong by mistake. Sometimes, people deliberately try to mislead you. Here are a few checks you can carry out to make sure your content is good quality.

- **Can you check the facts?** Check the information you find on a website against other websites before you use it.
- **When was the information written?** Check that your information is up to date.
- **Is the information on a site you trust?** As you bookmark websites, you will start to build a library of sites you have used many times and that you trust.
- **Is it fact or opinion?** Are opinions backed up by facts?



Does it upset you?

If something on the web upsets you or seems confusing:

- close the page and do not look at it again
- do not show or send it to anyone else
- tell an adult you trust, for example a parent, family member or teacher.

Reporting something that upsets you can be difficult, but it is important that you do. It can save others from being upset in the future. It can help you deal with the problem. It is not your fault.



Activity

Find a web page from the endangered animals activity in the last lesson. When was the information written?



Extra challenge

Revisit a website you have used in this unit. Use the 'Is it true?' questions to check its content. Then write a short report about your findings.

Think again

Search engines designed for young people show fewer adverts and control the content they show you.

Search for 'child-friendly search engine'. Then explore two of the search engines from the first page of results.

2.6 Be sure, be safe

In this lesson

You will learn:

- how to stay safe when talking to people online
- how to report problems you experience when using the internet.

Staying safe

- **Chatting** Do not chat with strangers online. It is safer to chat to people you know well. It is safest if you chat to people you know in real life. Don't accept friend requests from strangers. If you feel uncomfortable about someone who sends you a message, you can block them.
- **Sharing** Do not share your personal information or photographs with strangers. Never share your address or phone number with strangers.
- **Opening files** Do not open pictures or other files from people you don't know. If you receive something by email from someone you don't know, do not open it. If you are in doubt, ask an adult you trust for help.
- **Settings** Social media and games sites allow you to set **privacy levels**. Privacy levels let you decide who can see what you share online. If you are unsure how to use privacy settings, ask a family member or teacher to help you. Check your friends list. Make sure you haven't added strangers by accident.

Be kind and respectful

The way you behave online is important. Be kind and respectful in the way you talk to people. Chat online in the same way you would chat at home or in the classroom.

If someone you know is upset or frightened by something they have seen online, offer them help. Advise them to talk to a **trusted adult**.

If you see a friend acting irresponsibly online, share your knowledge of how to stay safe with them.

Reporting problems

If something scares or upsets you online, tell an adult. You will feel better once the problem is in the open. Remember, you are not to blame, and people want to help.

- Tell a family member you trust and can talk to.
- Talk to a teacher you trust. Your school may have a teacher responsible for dealing with online abuse and bullying.

Write down what happened so you can remember the details when you talk to a trusted adult.





Activity

Read your school's advice on using the internet. Make sure you know what your responsibilities are. Make sure you know how to report a problem.



Extra challenge

Make a list of three things your school policy says you should not do when using computers.

Make a list of three things you should do when using computers in school.

Think again

How would you act if something you saw or read on the internet upset or frightened you? Think about who your trusted adults are. Who would you talk to at school and at home if you needed to?

Do you need to ask for help to manage your privacy settings? Make an action list.

Check what you know

You have learned

- how to find information using a web search
- how to spot unsuitable content and behaviour on the internet and world wide web
- how you can report your concerns if you see content or behaviour that upsets you.

Test

1. What is a web browser used for?
2. Why should you check when information on a website was written?
3. Who should you talk to if you are upset about something you see or read online?
4. Alice is researching a geography project. She needs to find out what the longest rivers in the world are, apart from rivers in Europe. Write a search question that will find the information for Alice.
5. How can you check if a fact you have read on a web page is true?
6. List four things you can do to stay safe online.
7. What is a bookmark and what is it used for?
8. List three things you can do to check if the information you find on a website is reliable.
9. What steps should you take if someone sends you an upsetting message online?



Activities

1 Research the web for information on how to stay safe on the internet. You will find some advice on this site:

www.childnet.com/young-people/primary

2 Use your search skills to find advice from other websites. Bookmark the best ones in a folder called 'Staying safe online'.

3 Use the information from your research and this unit to create an information sheet. Write the sheet to help younger children in your school stay safe on the internet.

Self-evaluation

- I answered test questions 1, 2 and 3.
- I followed the link in activity 1 and read advice about staying safe.
- I answered test questions 1–6.
- I completed activities 1 and 2. I found information on the same topic from different websites and bookmarked the best information.
- I answered all the test questions.
- I completed all the activities.

Re-read any parts of the unit you feel unsure about. Try the test and activities again – can you do more this time?